Kirill Demidov

Data Engineering Lead | FinOps, Product Metrics & AI-Native Analytics

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Data engineering lead who owns both sides of the platform: the product metrics decisions run on, and the cloud bill that produces them. Cut BigQuery spend by 50% through slot reservation redesign and per-team cost attribution, and run FinOps as a standing discipline — cost dashboards, query analyzers, and budget monitoring — not a one-off cleanup. 18 years in BI and data platforms, the last 6 leading teams in mobile gaming and adtech on GCP, now building AI-native tooling (MCP servers, agentic workflows) that keeps AI coding agents effective in a real codebase.

EXPERIENCE

Data Engineering Lead

GOAT Entertainment Studios (HitZone Games, 1UP) | Israel | July 2024 - Present

Own the analytics platform behind both live titles of the holding — Invokers (HitZone Games) and Urban Heat (1UP): Dataform/BigQuery modelling, revenue and UA data marts, data quality, self-service BI, GCP cost ownership, and production ML for game balance.

- Own the analytics warehouse: 254 Dataform/BigQuery models across product, finance, marketing, and monitoring, with 125 automated data-quality assertions.
- Brought store revenue in-house — a daily Apple/Google reconciliation that matches the finance golden source to the cent, and caught a double-counting bug that had inflated reported revenue.
- Built the UA/marketing mart — attribution, creative-level cost, cohort revenue and retention — as the single source of truth for spend decisions.
- Built and run a self-service BI portal (Python/FastAPI on Cloud Run) serving 12 dashboards to product, finance, and UA, with pipeline observability and Slack alerting.
- Built Hero Index and a RAPM-style ML model (Cloud Run) that replaced subjective balance votes with 15.67M real battles, lifting the PvE balance signal from 0.56 to 0.85 correlation.
- Own GCP FinOps for the data platform — cut BigQuery spend by 50% through a slot reservation redesign (400-slot baseline vs. 700+ peak), with no loss of query performance for downstream teams.
- Made cloud cost visible and owned: built a BigQuery cost dashboard and a query analyzer that attribute spend to teams, queries, and pipelines, turning an opaque monthly bill into per-owner accountability.
- Led the GitLab→GitHub monorepo migration (29 repos → 3) and introduced the Service Brain Pattern — a pre-development documentation standard that keeps AI coding agents and engineers aligned on service context.

Data Engineering Lead

Arpeely | Tel Aviv, Israel | July 2022 - July 2024

Leading the data engineering team, building scalable data infrastructure, and developing BI solutions using Google Cloud, BigQuery, and Dataform.

- Refactored ELT pipelines from custom Python to scalable Dataform solution.
- Designed and implemented a corporate Data Warehouse and Data Lake in GCP.
- Deployed Looker-based BI system from scratch.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines for DWH and reporting.
- Developed a data governance monitoring system.

Data Engineering Lead

Tango.me | Tel Aviv, Israel | July 2021 - July 2022

Managed a team of data engineers and BI developers, implementing data pipelines and analytics solutions in GCP.

- Led a team of 6 data engineers and BI developers.
- Developed corporate Data Lake and Data Warehouse in GCP with Airflow and dbt.
- Implemented data governance and data quality monitoring using SelectStar and SodaSQL.
- Designed and built analytics and operational reports on Looker.

Big Data Team Lead

Alterosmart Solutions | Tel Aviv, Israel | December 2019 - July 2021

Led the Big Data team, designing and implementing data pipelines, data warehouses, and analytics solutions for industrial IoT systems.

- Analyzed business requirements, designed, and implemented Big Data modules in PDC systems.
- Developed and optimized ETL/ELT processes for IIoT systems (PDC, BMS) using Apache NiFi, Data Build Tool, and Spark.
- Designed and implemented an operational Data Warehouse for PDC application data using PostgreSQL.
- Built a Data Mart module for Atlassian Jira Software based on PostgreSQL and Cube.js.
- Developed and visualized analytical reports for DF data processing.

Senior BI Developer

SafeCharge | Tel Aviv, Israel | August 2018 - December 2019

Designed and developed BI solutions, Data Marts, and reporting systems, while maintaining ETL processes for internal analytics.

- Analyzed business requirements and designed Data Marts for internal clients.
- Maintained an ETL platform based on SSIS.
- Developed a semantic layer using SSAS (OLAP Cube).
- Designed and implemented a reporting system using SSRS and Power BI.
- Migrated OLAP-based BI system to a Big Data environment using AWS Data Lake (S3), ELT pipelines with Apache NiFi and Spark (PySpark), and MemSQL as the semantic layer.

BI Project Manager / BI & Big Data Engineer

Data Cube | Tel Aviv, Israel | January 2014 - August 2018

Managed BI projects and developed BI & Big Data solutions for various enterprises.

- Managed BI projects for enterprise clients including BioCatch, Postal Bank, Panaya, and Amdocs.
- Managed BI projects from conceptualization to full implementation.
- Analyzed business requirements and developed project deliverables.
- Maintained ETL platforms using SSIS, Python, and T-SQL.
- Designed and implemented Data Marts and Data Warehouses for internal analytics systems.
- Developed OLAP and Tabular Cube semantic layers.
- Implemented reporting systems using Pyramid BI Office, SSRS, Necto Panorama, Power BI, and Business Objects.
- Served major clients including BioCatch, Postal Bank of Israel, Bituach Yashir, Mimun Yashir, MKS Instruments, Taglit Birthright Israel, Panaya, Reuth Medical Rehabilitation Center, Medinol, LiderForex, and Amdocs.

Head of Data Management and Data Integration Department

Company for Location and Restitution of Holocaust Victims' Assets | Israel | January 2008 - January 2014

Led data management initiatives, developed data integration tools, and managed ETL and reporting systems.

- Developed knowledge management tools using MS SQL Server 2012.
- Designed and managed ETL processes for data integration and reporting.
- Created, managed, and supported a SharePoint-based database system.
- Led a team in developing research projects, providing training, and knowledge sharing.

SKILLS

AI-Native Data Engineering: MCP Server Architecture, Agentic Workflows, RAG Architecture, Claude Code, Multi-Agent Tooling, Vector Databases (Qdrant)

FinOps & Cloud Cost: BigQuery Slot Reservations, Cost Attribution & Showback, Query Cost Analysis, GCP Billing Analytics, Budget Monitoring & Alerting, Capacity Planning

Data Platform: BigQuery, Dataform, dbt, Dimensional Modelling, Data Quality & Assertions, Apache Airflow

Analytics & BI: Product Analytics, Revenue Reconciliation, UA Attribution, Funnel & Cohort Analysis, Looker, Power BI

Cloud & Engineering: Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Cloud Run, Python / FastAPI, SQL, Docker, CI/CD

PUBLICATIONS

- Merge in BigQuery and DML Limits: How to Overcome Upsert Restrictions — Medium, 2024. https://medium.com/@kirkademidov/merge-in-bigquery-and-dml-limits-how-to-overcome-upsert-restrictions-dc7507d6d997
- Alleviating the Headaches of Data Schema Changes for Engineers — Medium, 2024. https://medium.com/@kirkademidov/alleviating-the-headaches-of-data-schema-changes-for-engineers-8d6cb5f0b946

PATENTS & AWARDS

- Patent: Data acquisition and processing platform for internet of things analysis and control — USPTO (US 10,838,836), 2020.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Master Political Science, Hebrew University of Jerusalem (2012-2014)
- Bachelor Political Science, Hebrew University of Jerusalem (2004-2008)
- MCSE Certification Business Intelligence, John Bryce College (2013-2014)
- Professional Certification Google BigQuery for Data and ML Engineers, Google Cloud / Coursera (2024-2024)
- Course Hands-On Analytics Engineering, Analytics Engineering / Masthead Data (2024-2024)
- AI Developer Certification Beyond Vibe Coding with Google Gemini, AI Developer Community (2024-2024)

LANGUAGES

Hebrew (Native speaker), Russian (Native speaker), English (Fluent)